

Seoul. And the corporation gives what's left of our money back to us as a stock dividend.

Or we can buy treasury bonds and have our investment protected by the sacred trust of the United States government. When we go to redeem the bonds the government will say, "Oops, we spent all that money. But don't worry, we've printed a whole bunch of new money. If you mail your bonds to the treasury, they'll be redeemed at full value. That will be \$425 for a stamp, please."

And we know there are many other ways for us to loose our shirts because we've watched John Rothchild run around topless for 272 pages.

Of course, there are a few things John Rothchild didn't try. We could steal. Or if we feel too scrupulous for that, we could take money from people, pay ourselves lavish salaries, buy real estate in Seoul and say it's okay because we're a corporation.

We could become a government and make everybody give us 38% of what they earn because we're going to be out of office before we have to give anything back.

And we could donate our money to worthwhile causes. Instead of investing in our earthly future, we could be investing in eternal bliss. Except things may work the same way in heaven as they do down here. We may get to the pearly gates only to have St. Peter tell us, "Good deed futures have gone to hell."

So in the end, we are left with the one great lesson that *A Fool and His Money* teaches us, a lesson that does not vary with time or circumstances, a lesson that is wise, powerful and true: Give your money to your wife.

P.J. O'ROURKE